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Property Investment Purchase Checklist — Western Australia

Due diligence for buying an investment property — including WA's distinctive land tax position.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only — not financial, tax or legal advice. Engage a qualified accountant, mortgage broker, and conveyancer/settlement agent before purchasing.

Section 1 — Structuring the Purchase

- [ ] **Decide on ownership structure before you buy** — individual, joint, trust, or company each carry different land tax and asset-protection implications.
- [ ] **Understand WA's land tax threshold.** Land tax applies once your aggregated taxable WA landholdings exceed **$300,000**.
- [ ] **Know WA is one of the most foreign-investor-friendly states for land tax.** Unlike NSW, VIC, and QLD, Western Australia currently imposes **no separate foreign owner land tax surcharge** — though foreign buyers should still budget for foreign transfer duty at purchase, and this settled position is periodically reconsidered by government, so confirm it hasn't changed before relying on it for a major investment decision.
- [ ] **If your property is in metropolitan Perth, check the Metropolitan Region Improvement Tax (MRIT).** This applies at **0.14%** on the value above $300,000, in addition to standard land tax, for properties in the metro region.
- [ ] **Get investment-specific finance pre-approval** — investment lending is assessed differently to owner-occupier lending.

Section 2 — Due Diligence on the Property Itself

- [ ] **Order a building and pest inspection before you sign** — remember, WA has no cooling-off period, so this needs to happen (or be a robust contract condition) before, not after, signing.
- [ ] **Have a settlement agent or solicitor review the contract before you sign.**
- [ ] **If buying a strata property, review the strata records thoroughly** — sinking fund health and special levies directly affect your investment returns.
- [ ] **Research the local rental market specifically** — vacancy rates, comparable rents, and tenant demand for your target Perth suburb or regional centre.

Section 3 — Setting Up for Compliance From Day One

- [ ] **Budget for landlord obligations under the Residential Tenancies Act 1987**, and stay alert to the proposed no-grounds eviction reform — if it passes, it will materially change how you manage tenancy endings going forward.
- [ ] **Decide on self-management vs. a property manager** — particularly relevant given the active reform environment in WA tenancy law right now.
- [ ] **Arrange landlord insurance**, separate from standard building insurance.
- [ ] **Engage a quantity surveyor for a tax depreciation schedule** shortly after settlement — see the separate Tax & Depreciation Checklist in this series.

Section 4 — Understanding the Current Tax Environment

- [ ] **Be aware Commonwealth CGT settings for investment property are changing**, with reforms affecting the CGT discount generally applying from 1 July 2027 — confirm the finalised current position with your accountant.
- [ ] **Get advice on purchase and sale timing relative to this changeover** if your investment horizon spans the 2027 transition.

Quick Reference — WA Investment Property Snapshot (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Land tax threshold	$300,000
Foreign owner land tax surcharge	**None** — WA is currently an outlier here
Metropolitan Region Improvement Tax (Perth metro)	0.14% above $300,000
Cooling-off period	None — inspection/finance must be resolved pre-signature
No-grounds eviction reform	Proposed, not yet law as at July 2026

Land tax settings change with state budgets — always confirm current figures with RevenueWA before settling on a purchase strategy.